

SATIE AND DEBUSSY, 1910

Satie (right) is pictured with his friend and fellow composer Claude Debussy in the latter's home on the Avenue du Bois de Boulogne, Paris.

Influences and collaborations

As Satie gradually made his name as a composer, opinions about him became divided: the older disciples of Debussy, including Ravel, admired Satie's early pieces, while those of the younger generation latched on to the Modernism of his more recent work. He gathered around him a group of young acolytes—including Georges Auric, Louis Durey, and Arthur Honegger—that he wished to be known as Les Nouveaux Jeunes. Although members of the group composed in a variety of styles, they shared an affinity with Satie's rejection of both Romanticism and Debussy's Impressionism. When Satie parted from the Jeunes following the success of his ballet *Parade* in 1917, the other members gathered around Cocteau and later became known as Les Six. Satie meanwhile continued to develop his own idiosyncratic style, much influenced by the artistic movements of the time (see [box](#)). In 1919, he completed what many regard as his masterpiece, *Socrate*, an enigmatic Modernist work scored for chamber orchestra and four sopranos who sing sections from Plato's dialogues. The composition confounded critics (used to Satie's whimsical works) with its profundity, sincerity, and intimacy.

Satie died of cirrhosis of the liver in 1925. For the last 27 years of his life, he lived alone in chaos among unopened mail,